

Resurrection thru re-invitation

Will you pray with me?

Abundance, restoration, invitational God

Full circle, mirror moments, finally see

Tender, tending (loyalty & faithfulness,
cooperation & harmony, peace,
forgiveness, reconciliation, heart as
endurance & patience)

He's gone back to what he knows –
fishing. But it's sheep in the image Jesus
offers

God comes to meet us where we will see,
know, feel. In a way uniquely ours. I
personally have been fishing only once or
twice,

You will do greater things than these
(john 14) a second call. To nourish
spiritually. Shepherd, guarding &
guiding.

Jesus trusts Peter with it

Have to go through it. Be where you at.
No denying. Bold, brash.

Its not just the well-behaved, moral ones
who are entrusted with Jesus's ministry.
Peter is a whole person, just like us. It's
that he lets love & faith lead. Love with
endurance, patience. "here's my heart"

What's different on this side of the
resurrection?

Death isn't the end of the story. But
neither is resurrection. The call is
perpetual. A journey.

Where is God inviting KCC? No matter
where we've been on our journey, what
our struggles & pitfalls are.

Will you pray with me? Oh Creator, God who seeks us out, pour your Spirit on us in a special way this day. We are longing to give our hearts to you, and to know you cherish our love and call us ever onward. We hope & trust we'll feel you with us this day. In the name of the Risen Christ, Amen.

Good morning KCC! Did you know that Easter is a whole season, not just that one Sunday of fancy clothes & egg hunts & full-belly, full-hearts dinners? This is the second Sunday of Easter, another resurrection Sunday so we can still say “Christ is risen!” “He is risen indeed!” last week, Stephen drew us into the theme of resurrections in our own lives—the hell & back journeys we go on to resurrect new & beautiful versions of ourselves. Through facing the good Friday moments & the betrayal

moments, without denying them, we come to co-create a new self with God. We have journeyed with Peter through his resurrection story, from moments where he followed his curiosity, to those where he felt overwhelmed with insecurity, dropping to Jesus's feet saying he's not worthy, to flip flopping from "you can't wash my feet!" to "not just my feet, but also my hands & my head!," to denying he even knew the man who washed him. Peter is not a meek & mild lamb following his Good Shepherd. Peter is going to ask the questions & cry & argue in whatever bold & brash way he feels prone to at the time. I have to say, this series has me wondering about Peter's personality a bit more too, how about you? He may be a bit prone to melodrama, maybe a theatrical background? Or that's probably just me seeing myself in him. What do you see? For while we all respond to the

resurrection differently, I so admire the way Peter lets himself be *exactly where he is at*. No denying, no tucking it away, just being in process. Being honest. From his faith to his doubts, his courage to his pitfalls, honest & real. Thanks be to God.

And so we find Peter, this wandering heart, several days after running to the empty tomb, and he is fishing. Was he simply going back to what he knew, something comforting amidst the grief & wondering? What seems true is that he longed for his friend, who, while resurrected, was not around in the “brotherly love” sort of way anymore. Or so he thought, but then Jesus appears again, in a familiar, comforting way, by the lake, with instructions for where to cast their nets once more.

And as at the beginning of their earthly time together, Jesus’s guidance leads the

fishermen to an incredibly abundant catch. Jesus is back, and Jesus's abundance is too! Thanks be to God, Peter can't wait to get close to him, and dives out to swim. He recognizes this Christ because Christ seeks him in a way that is comforting, familiar, recognizable. It's my experience & belief too that Jesus meets each of us in our unique ways, in the spaces that are comforting to us. God will draw us in by seeking us where we are at, in a way we will recognize, because God offers God's heart to us, especially in our moments of grief & sadness.

Jesus sets a table for Peter & the disciples, offering them a nourishing meal & serving them once more. If there was any doubt amongst the group as to who this was, they know in the breaking of the bread that this is the Risen Christ. Jesus already had fish to serve, but

asked that they bring some they've just caught to the meal. They share thus their resources, Jesus makes theirs equivalent with his, and reminds them of the miraculous feeding of the 5000, where he urged the disciples to figure it out, that they could solve the problem of feeding so many hungry without his help. The meal is a collective effort, where Jesus encourages the disciples agency even as he offers support. The moment has come, though, where they will need to remember his teachings without him being there. "*You will do greater things than these,*" he said at the Last Supper. Greater miracles & teachings & ministries than Jesus? Could it be so? They sit remembering, and yet a few days ago it didn't seem that resurrection could be so. Impossible things are happening, perhaps this can too?? They realize they don't need to ask again if resurrection is real, they're

coming to know it in their bones. The risen christ is with them. He seeks them out. They know it to be true. They're learning too to trust in abundance – from the catches of fish to the resources they have to share to the never-ending love of God. God meets them there at this full circle moment, a moment of deeper understanding.

Jesus will have another conversation with Peter, just to be sure. Three times Peter had denied Christ, and three times Jesus asks him, “Peter do you love me?” alongside a call, stated most clearly this time: “Feed my sheep,” nourish them spiritually, tend the tender as I tend you, meeting you right here, right now. Though you denied me, I trust you with his ministry, this call. Jesus does not issue a formal forgiveness – why not, we might ask? Perhaps one isn't needed. Perhaps Peter's journey has been

wandering, but his heart has always been in it, all the way. And through invitation after invitation, he has followed. Maybe even when we feel shame for places along our way, we learn we can be honest with God. God will love us, and there ain't nothing we can do about it. God will invite us again & again, all our days. Invite us to love & be loved, to trust in abundance, to believe in our agency, to serve the one in front of us. For in so doing, we experience life more abundantly, more beautiful, more like resurrection.

Where is God inviting you? Your family? This church? How is the risen Christ seeking you out, personally, with love, love, love.

For the invitation is also to steadfastness, loyalty, and patience. To relationship with an invitational God, not a shaming one. To faithfulness where

even our moments of doubt & darkness are normal and dare-I-say good on the journey. God will meet you where you're at, be where you are.

God is still seeking us out, still calling us each here at KCC, no matter our foibles & doubts & struggles. Jesus entrusts Peter with continuing his ministry just as Jesus entrusts us. For it takes all of us, all along our journeys, to co-create life more abundantly for all. Jesus needs Peter to carry on & do "greater things than" he did. God needs KCC to embody resurrection, and invites us to it. What images will we notice? Jesus draws Peter's mind's eye to imagine himself as a shepherd, what images will God draw us into? What new ways of being might KCC find for itself in resurrection & life abundant? So let's be honest with ourselves & God about where we're at — like Peter, our moments where we feel

hopeless or shameful or turned away, for when we find that God loves us still, we trust in resurrection. Let's come together to remember Christ's teachings, and to believe together that we can do greater things than these. To offer our hearts, and lead with love, that all may have life & love & resurrection more abundant. Amen.